PRODUCT VISION / GAME RULES / DEVELOPMENT HANDOFF

HUNTER WORLD

Final App Concept & Development Brief

Your phone becomes your System. Your city becomes a hunting ground. Your actions become part of its history.

A persistent, shared world where an unawakened person can become a hunter, craftsperson, merchant, guild founder, or public leader. Each life accumulates consequences and can leave a history after death.

32	28	6
DESIGN SECTIONS	ACCEPTANCE CASES	ROLLOUT STAGES

Prepared for Author and Astra

Consolidated edition 1.0 | 11 September 2026

Internal planning baseline. The game is not yet implemented or validated in production. Hunter World is a descriptive working label; the commercial name and launch region remain planning decisions.

Contents

A consolidated baseline for planning, building, and verifying the game. Section titles and PDF bookmarks provide navigation.

01 | How to use this brief . . . 3
02 | Product identity and player experience . . . 4
03 | Core loops and first-session journey . . . 5
04 | Identity, account, and character lifecycle . . . 6
05 | Civilian life and access rules . . . 7
06 | The System panel and fullscreen identity . . . 8
07 | Map, presence, and geography . . . 9
08 | Gates, encounters, and combat . . . 10
09 | Awakening, classes, and advancement . . . 11
10 | Items, crafting, and professions . . . 12
11 | Direct trading and personal stalls . . . 13
12 | Registered local markets . . . 14
13 | World Exchange and delivery . . . 15
14 | Economic balance and monetization . . . 16
15 | Guilds and collective ownership . . . 17
16 | Forums, reporting, news, and sound . . . 18
17 | NPCs, hidden quests, and discoveries . . . 19
18 | PK, evidence, and the Blood Debt law . . . 20
19 | Gate breaks, invasions, and rescue . . . 22
20 | Permanent death, archives, and succession . . . 23
21 | Later national associations and WHA . . . 25
22 | Later story shaped by players . . . 26
23 | Visual, audio, and interaction direction . . . 27
24 | System architecture and trust boundaries . . . 28
25 | Data model and non-negotiable invariants . . . 29
26 | Security, reliability, and operator controls . . . 31
27 | End-to-end acceptance scenarios . . . 32
28 | Rollout stages and release gates . . . 34
29 | Evaluation, balance, and commercial realism . . . 35
30 | Planning decisions and starting defaults . . . 36
31 | Competitive context and source notes . . . 37
32 | Astra handoff and completeness checklist . . . 39

SECTION 01

How to use this brief

Authority and scope

The owner's latest instructions take precedence. This document consolidates them into one internally connected baseline. Earlier suggestions that conflict with later requirements have been reconciled explicitly: character creation no longer assigns a combat class; the one-character rule means one living character at a time; remote commerce complements proximity markets; and a dead character cannot return as an active participant after the cooldown.

Core rules are product commitments to preserve during planning. **Planning defaults** make a prototype concrete and may be adjusted with evidence. **Content examples** demonstrate the intended experience and do not constitute a completed class, item, or story catalog. **Later features** are part of the final vision but must not be represented as functioning in an earlier release.

The initial project is a multiplayer game with ongoing operations, rather than a static profile app. A browser build is a useful first development surface. The mobile release must be tested on real devices for GPS, permissions, reconnects, notifications, battery use, and proximity interactions.

What Astra should do next

Read the complete brief, derive a requirements backlog, and map dependencies before implementing game systems. Preserve a versioned game bible and decision log so development does not depend on remembering a long chat. Choose the stack and launch region during technical planning, using the decision defaults in Section 30. Implement a small complete experience, verify it with separate accounts, and expand through the release gates in Section 28.

Astra may resolve routine implementation choices within this baseline. Changes to permanent death, proximity access, hidden awakening, player freedom, ownership, or monetization must be called out as product changes. Keep developer-only rules and secret content out of public clients, public documentation, and forum templates.

SECTION 02

Product identity and player experience

The world people enter

The app overlays a fictional modern hunter society on real geography. Gates, guild locations, markets, NPC encounters, public gathering places, and eligible nearby players appear on the map. Gate combat opens a separate illustrated game environment. No camera view or augmented reality is required.

The player has a personal System panel, a recognizable character identity, and a history that other players can encounter through legitimate in-world records. The emotional goals are wonder, anticipation, recognition, danger, pride, cooperation, and the possibility of becoming exceptional. Everyday participation must still be rewarding for people who never lead a leaderboard.

The setting uses original lore, names, imagery, sounds, and characters. Solo Leveling and similar LitRPG stories describe the desired feeling of awakening and recognition; they are references for experience, not a supplied license or an instruction to reproduce an existing franchise.

Design principles

- **A lasting life:** one active identity accumulates achievements, relationships, discoveries, and consequences.
- **Civilian belonging:** unawakened people can earn, contribute, organize, and take risks from the beginning.
- **Earned distinction:** rank, rare paths, and significant titles reflect recorded accomplishments.
- **Geography with purpose:** exploration, encounters, local trade, and gatherings make places meaningful.
- **Agency with understandable consequences:** players can make dangerous decisions, including hostile ones, within explicit game rules.
- **A world with evidence:** public knowledge comes from records, reports, observation, and shared discoveries.
- **Reliable ownership:** combat, trades, rewards, and death follow server rules that can be audited and tested.
- **Manageable participation:** ordinary offline characters are sheltered; daily attendance is not required to avoid spontaneous death.

Ordinary and extraordinary players

Local recognition, guild service, rescue work, valuable reports, craftsmanship, and commercial reliability offer alternatives to raw combat power. Exceptional hunters can become famous without making everyone else irrelevant. New arrivals need attainable opportunities even after the first generation has accumulated wealth and discoveries.

SECTION 03

Core loops and first-session journey

Interlocking loops

Loop	Actions	Meaningful return
Hunter	Prepare, scout, enter a gate, fight, extract, improve a build	Loot, mastery, assessment eligibility, discoveries
Civilian	Gather information, complete work, supply others, report events	Income, professional growth, community relevance
Craftsperson	Acquire materials, learn recipes, fulfill commissions, refine techniques	Demand for distinctive work and access to advanced production
Merchant	Source goods, open a stall, fulfill orders, operate a market	Commercial standing and relationships
Guild	Recruit, prepare expeditions, share resources, complete projects	Collective identity, capability, and recorded achievements
Explorer	Investigate rumors, compare reports, find NPCs or unusual gates	Knowledge, hidden quests, rare opportunities

First session

The player creates an unawakened character, receives a civilian identity view, and learns the System panel. A short orientation introduces a reliable public hub, an ordinary NPC, public forums, available work, and map controls. The player can complete a low-risk information or supply task and receive a useful item or earned currency.

The first gate offers a clear danger assessment, preparation options, and a retreat explanation. Entering is a deliberate choice. A player may remain outside, join a willing party, or attempt entry with available tools. The introduction must demonstrate civilian participation even when the player does not awaken immediately.

A controlled awakening route is available through early play, but its internal requirements are not shown as a formula. The experience should suggest that unusual possibilities exist without promising a rare class. The first session should end with an understandable next objective and a reason to encounter another player.

Session lengths

Planning targets are roughly 2-5 minutes for a compact solo encounter and 10-15 minutes for a substantial party expedition. These are tuning targets, not guaranteed lengths. Traders, crafters, and forum participants must also have useful short sessions. A gate's estimated duration and ongoing exposure rules are shown before commitment.

SECTION 04

Identity, account, and character lifecycle

One living character

An account can have one living character at a time. A character has a stable internal ID, a public alias, an appearance, an origin date, recorded achievements, and configurable public information. Accounts and characters are separate records: the account manages access and purchases; the character owns its in-world life and standing.

The intended rule is one living character per real player. Account enforcement and anti-evasion measures support that rule, but no claim of perfect person identification should be made. Ordinary character death is not a reason to lock unrelated functions of a player's device.

Independent states

Dimension	States or values	Consequence
Life	Alive, incapacitated, permanently dead	Determines whether that character can act or be rescued
Awakening	Unawakened, awakened, later transformations	Determines access to innate mana and class capabilities
Presence	Sheltered, active field, committed encounter, disconnect recovery	Determines current exposure and permitted interactions
Account entry	Eligible, active-character occupied, death cooldown	Controls creation of a new living character
Public standing	Rank, professional credentials, titles, leaderboard position	Communicates different earned aspects of the character

Do not collapse these dimensions into one status. An unawakened craftsperson can be influential, an S-rank hunter can be incapacitated, and a dead character can retain an archived title without retaining authority to act.

Character continuity

Build experimentation and skill resets are permitted within defined progression rules. Rare transformations require their own content and eligibility. A reset cannot manufacture an awakening, remove Blood Debt, erase a death, or turn the character into an unrelated second identity. Account cosmetics may survive death; character power and wealth do not automatically transfer to the next life.

SECTION 05

Civilian life and access rules

What unawakened characters can do

Unawakened players can use public markets and forums, take civilian contracts, trade, study, gather eligible materials, craft within their training and equipment limits, and publish gate or event reports. They can perform reconnaissance, carry supplies, provide ordinary first aid, and accompany a party that accepts them.

They may join guilds according to guild policy. A non-combat founding route lets qualified organizers or merchants establish guilds. Hunter-exclusive contracts, channels, offices, or equipment still enforce their own stated requirements. Profession-specific access can be earned without hunter status.

Dangerous entry

Hunter rank is generally a recommendation and certification, not a universal gate-entry prohibition. A low-powered or unawakened character can attempt a dangerous gate if its actual entry conditions are satisfied. Keys, capacity, special seals, or an event's explicit rules can still restrict access. A guild's refusal to admit someone to its expedition does not become a universal ban on that person exploring independently.

The entry view describes known threats, estimated power demands, party composition, time commitment, and death exposure. Unknown properties remain unknown. Consuming a charged item may allow an unawakened character to use a stored effect; it does not silently grant an awakened mana pool.

Information as contribution

Reports identify the author's observations, time, approximate in-world location, and any attached evidence. An unverified report remains a claim. System-confirmed encounter facts can be attached without revealing secret algorithms or another player's private data. Useful reporting can earn contract rewards and professional standing when verified, with controls against repetitive low-value submissions and collusive reward farming.

SECTION 06

The System panel and fullscreen identity

Primary screens

Surface	Essential content	Main actions
System	Character, current condition, active objectives, build, recent changes	Inspect status, manage equipment, open quests
Map	Gates, hubs, markets, eligible NPCs and opted-in presence	Inspect, travel safely, enter, assemble, evacuate
Activity	Encounter state, preparation, combat, extraction, rescue	Act, use items, cooperate, withdraw
Community	Public boards, guild spaces, recruitment, reports, news	Read, post, recruit, submit evidence
Inventory and commerce	Owned items, orders, crafting jobs, stall controls	Equip, craft, trade, sell, receive

Use a persistent quick-access control for the body-status panel and the ID card. The exact navigation layout can be refined through usability testing, but these functions must not be buried behind several menus.

Identity card

Before awakening, the card shows the character's registered identity and relevant civilian or professional credentials. After awakening it can display hunter rank, class visibility, guild crest, selected title, and verified highlights. The owner chooses whether to disclose subclass, equipment details, exact statistics, or a broader achievement history.

Fullscreen mode is readable at arm's length, with a distinctive rank presentation and a QR code for a limited public profile, friend request, party invitation, or trade invitation. QR possession does not authorize a trade or disclose private data. A saved image is a snapshot; current eligibility and transaction authority require a fresh server check.

Character body status

Display current and maximum HP, usable MP or Dormant, stamina, injuries, poison, bleeding, impairments, temporary buffs, and relevant encounter or evacuation states. These are fictional character conditions. Color is reinforced by labels and icons. Critical information remains readable with animation reduced and sound disabled.

Promotions and major awakenings receive a short visual, audio, and haptic presentation. Routine notifications remain restrained so significant moments retain impact.

SECTION 07

Map, presence, and geography

Discoverable places

The map supports gates, public hubs, markets, guild gathering locations, event zones, and eligible NPC encounters. Filters distinguish risk, content type, access requirements, and availability. The map should remain usable in areas with fewer players, with a minimum supply of appropriate encounters and access to useful solo or remote activities.

Public gathering places and commercial locations must be suitable for intended access. Reported inaccessible or inappropriate locations can be reviewed, moved, or disabled. Opening hours and access boundaries matter. A market or guild marker does not grant permission to enter private property.

Player visibility

Public presence is off by default. Players choose to appear for assembling, social discovery, or an active personal stall. Broader discovery uses approximate areas; encounter membership can expose the character identities needed for the game. The app must not offer an unrestricted history of another person's exact movements.

Trade presence and hostile encounter eligibility are separate permissions. Showing a stall does not make its warded trading area a combat arena. A public alias in a raid or a PK report is not permission to reveal that player's real address or travel trail.

Proximity and virtual movement

Physical proximity determines access to local catalogs and transactions. A planning default is approximately 100 meters for a direct trade and 150 meters for a local market, adjusted after GPS and access testing. Exact values are configuration, not fixed lore. Significant uncertainty in a location fix should produce an explanation and retry path rather than an accusation of cheating.

The character's virtual encounter position is distinct from the phone's physical location. Emergency evacuation and combat movement occur inside game rules. Virtual arrival at a hub never grants physical browsing or collection rights there. After shelter, returning to active field play uses the current validated physical area and a defined entry state.

SECTION 08

Gates, encounters, and combat

Gate families

Family	Experience	Key requirements
Standard	Solo or small-party dungeon with a clear objective	Preparation, tactical choices, reliable extraction rules
Unstable	Changing conditions, alternative routes, optional risks	Communicated instability and recorded state changes
Raid	Coordinated multi-role expedition and boss phases	Party readiness, contribution credit, reconnect handling
Invasion	Shared defense and evacuation after a break	Regional objectives, civilian actions, bounded exposure
Hidden	Rare access or discovery tied to eligible conditions	Secret content protected by server eligibility

A gate moves through announced or discovered, open, active, resolved or expired, and possibly breach states. Party instances and regional event state are separate: completing one instance must not accidentally resolve the world event for everyone unless that event is designed for a single shared outcome.

Combat baseline

The recommended first implementation is tactical turn-based combat with illustrated enemies, clear ability effects, and cinematic presentation for major actions. Players choose targets, skills, items, defensive actions, and withdrawal attempts. Party play uses bounded decision rounds, with an explicit fallback action for an absent participant.

Roles contribute through damage, healing, protection, interruption, control, resource management, and information. Boss phases should create decisions, not merely larger health totals. Expected action timing, round deadlines, damage curves, and resource costs are tuning work for the combat prototype.

Equipment and consumables allow preparation to matter. Do not equate buying a high-rank weapon with automatically mastering it. Encounter rewards credit useful support and eligible objectives, not just the final hit. Reward and loot rules are visible before joining; personal drops and explicitly declared shared objectives avoid an uncontrolled last-hit economy.

Commitment and extraction

Players receive a preparation and readiness stage. A committed dangerous encounter cannot be abandoned instantly by closing the app. Retreat is a game action with known conditions and possible costs. Critical state changes, rewards, extraction, injuries, and deaths are finalized once by the server and remain consistent after reconnecting.

SECTION 09

Awakening, classes, and advancement

Separate kinds of progress

Progression	Meaning
Level	Ongoing experience and growth within the progression model
Hunter rank, E through S initially	Certification earned through role-appropriate assessments
Class and subclass	How the character channels power and contributes
Class rarity	Unusual capabilities and difficulty of accessing a path
Professional credentials	Crafting, trading, research, or organizational qualifications
Ranker standing	Seasonal position in local, regional, or global competition

A common path can develop into an exceptional character. Permanent rank belongs to that living character, while seasonal leaderboards can reset without erasing its life history. Assessments must recognize protection, healing, and control as well as damage. Above-S categories should only be added when content and balance justify them.

Hidden awakening engine

Awakening is evaluated by server-side rules using recorded quests, achievements, acquired items, qualifying actions, and world conditions. Each route has prerequisites, a trigger, eligibility exclusions, an outcome definition, and a version. Some eligible routes are deterministic; others use a recorded random outcome. Repeat requests cannot reroll the same event.

The exact formula remains developer-only. Players encounter clues and can infer patterns through experience and community research. Secret requirements must remain consistent enough that discovery is meaningful. Store the rule version and qualifying evidence privately so a result can be investigated without publishing its recipe.

Ordinary awakening has multiple dependable internal routes. Rare or mythic opportunities can demand much more unusual combinations. A bought catalyst can satisfy acquisition criteria, but cannot replace separate personal requirements. No premium purchase directly grants an awakening or improves a rare awakening lottery.

Class content strategy

The initial awakened archetypes are Warrior, Mage, Ranger, Assassin, Guardian, and Healer. A modest number of distinct specializations establishes real variety before the catalog expands. Content examples include Guardian to Runebastion, emphasizing protective formations and redirected attacks, and Mage to Starcaller, using delayed celestial attacks and gravity effects.

Professional awakening paths, including advanced smithing, alchemy, and artificing, expand the catalog later. Every class definition needs a purpose, usable actions, resource model, strengths, limitations, growth route, and party contribution. Legendary and mythic labels require distinctive play, rather than only stronger numbers.

Rare one-time discoveries can award unique titles, appearances, artifacts, or limited paths. Essential roles and basic progression remain obtainable through other routes. Build resets cannot bypass class eligibility or manufacture completed hidden quests.

SECTION 10

Items, crafting, and professions

Item structure

Each item has a stable definition for rank, rarity, effects, eligibility, trade policy, condition, and provenance. Individual items have instance IDs; stacks have auditable quantities. Unique artifacts have explicit supply limits.

Rank measures power or handling demands. Rarity measures scarcity and unusual function. A D-rank legendary tool can offer a distinctive benefit without being stronger in every respect than A-rank ordinary equipment. Detailed balance must prevent rarity labels from becoming misleading decoration.

Equipping, consuming, listing, shipping, crafting with, lending, and dropping an item are controlled transitions. The same instance or units cannot occupy incompatible states at once. A charged artifact can provide an effect to an unawakened user when its definition allows it; the artifact supplies the energy.

Professional families

Profession	Products and services	Advanced possibilities
Medicine and healer craft	First aid, antidotes, restorative preparations	Recovery support, protective preparations, specialized stabilizers
Blacksmithing	Weapons, armor, repairs, modifications	Advanced forging, enchantment-compatible equipment
Alchemy	Refined monster materials, reagents, consumables	Catalysts and unusual effects
Artificing	Charged tools, detectors, specialist equipment	Spatial devices and sophisticated utility gear
Scribing and research	Scrolls, seals, maps, verified records	Rare diagrams, research discoveries, high-value intelligence

Professions can begin before awakening. Advanced effects depend on training, recipes, materials, tools, facilities, and sometimes compatible classes. A character can retain its combat identity while developing a commercial or crafting career.

Crafting and commissions

A recipe specifies ingredients, qualifications, duration, outputs, possible quality variations, and any disclosed failure risk. Starting a job reserves or consumes ingredients according to the recipe; retrying a request cannot create another output. The player can inspect completion and delivery status after reconnecting.

Commissions specify the exact product, allowed quality range, supplied materials, fee, deadline, and cancellation rules. Escrow holds payment and materials. An output must meet the agreed specification before payment is released. Vague text promises are insufficient for automatic settlement.

Crafting consumes materials. Consumables, repairs, and specialization sustain demand. Item histories can credit crafters and verified origins without revealing private location trails or hidden quest conditions.

SECTION 11

Direct trading and personal stalls

Direct exchange

Two living, eligible characters establish a nearby trade session. A Hunter ID QR scan can initiate the invitation, but both parties accept independently. Offers may contain eligible items, earned currency, or both. The interface shows names, quantities, ranks, conditions, restrictions, and the complete exchange before confirmation.

Any edit clears prior confirmations. Final settlement rechecks ownership, eligibility, proximity, balances, and the unchanged offer version. Both sides transfer together or neither does. A timeout, death, cancellation, or failed eligibility check releases reservations without duplicating or destroying goods.

The server supplies a receipt to both players. Avoid item-dropping as the standard trade method. Historical price information can inform a decision, but the game does not guarantee that every negotiated price is objectively fair.

Temporary solo stall

A player explicitly opens a stall in an eligible area. They select inventory, fixed prices, accepted barter interests, and a brief description. Nearby users can inspect the permitted catalog while the seller remains in the trading session. The stall closes when the seller ends it, leaves the allowed area, or becomes ineligible.

Fixed-price purchases can settle automatically from reserved inventory. Barter requires an accepted final offer. Public stall presence exposes only the information needed to find and interact with that stall. It does not publish the seller's movements after the stall closes.

Safeguards and edge cases

Reserve a chosen listing briefly during checkout and return it when checkout expires. Revalidate location at settlement, with sensible handling of GPS uncertainty. Previously seen screenshots cannot be made secret again; proximity controls govern fresh access and transaction eligibility. A report about a trade opens an evidence process and does not let the reporter seize property.

SECTION 12

Registered local markets

Founding and operation

A qualified player or guild can establish a named market at a suitable public location. A solo owner may operate it and may invite other vendors. The founding route includes a Merchant License quest, completed commercial contracts, an earned-currency registration cost, an eligible location, and active stock. Size and capacity increase through commercial achievements and maintained activity.

Market eligibility is independent of being a powerful hunter. The owner can choose branding, specialties, operating hours, vendor admission, and a bounded commission schedule. Material fees and policies are displayed before a vendor deposits goods. Owner changes cannot retroactively rewrite a transaction that has already been accepted.

From outside the interaction area, users see the name, crest, opening times, vendor count, and broad specialties. Full local listings, current prices, purchasing, and barter unlock nearby. Remote search cannot silently reveal the complete local catalog.

Deposited inventory

Vendors deposit listed goods into market custody. Fixed-price sales can occur while the vendor is offline; the buyer must still be physically present. Barter proposals wait for the seller's response, and the buyer must be eligible and nearby at final settlement. Proposed goods remain unavailable for conflicting uses while reserved.

Listings can be withdrawn only when no accepted order or active reservation prevents it. A market owner cannot confiscate vendor goods as an administrative action. Closure, suspension, or owner death returns uncommitted stock through a defined storage channel, while settled obligations remain intact.

Why players visit

Local markets offer immediate access, direct negotiation, local specialties, crafting services, buy orders, and a social gathering point. Guild procurement contracts can attract suppliers before a raid. Scheduled fairs and later auctions are expansion content after ordinary trading is reliable. Auction bidding and collection must retain the access rules advertised for that event.

Markets use warded trading areas. An invasion can suspend access or close a venue, but cannot create an unannounced duplication, confiscation, or destruction of goods already held in secure custody.

SECTION 13

World Exchange and delivery

Remote commerce

The World Exchange is an in-world online shop that can be used without visiting a place. A seller intentionally lists an item there. The buyer sees the exact product, total price, fees, destination, expected delivery time, and applicable modifiers before accepting. Remote and local listings share the same ownership ledger; an item cannot be sold through both simultaneously.

The fiction is a courier network connecting storage and commercial hubs. A delivery destination is fixed at purchase, such as the buyer's registered storage inbox. Moving the phone does not endlessly reroute the parcel or shorten its agreed trip. Successful delivery makes the item usable without a required real-world collection journey.

Delivery state and modifiers

Orders move through reserved, paid or funded, in transit, delivered, cancelled or failed under explicit policies. Funds remain held until the applicable settlement point. Delivery timing can depend on a virtual route, item handling needs, and known event conditions. Display revised estimates and a bounded resolution path for service delays.

Earned items or statuses can reduce or bypass transit: charged Spatial Anchors, Courier Pacts, or earned delivery privileges are examples. Conditions, charges, and cooldowns are explicit. Eligibility is checked against already owned, usable resources. A bypass item inside the new shipment cannot be consumed before arrival to accelerate itself.

Instant delivery does not bypass equipment requirements, death, storage capacity rules, or encounter restrictions on accessing outside supplies. The purchase screen must explain restrictions that affect immediate usability. Delivery privileges are earned gameplay benefits, not a premium shortcut to combat power.

Remote barter and exceptional outcomes

Remote barter holds both offers, verifies the unchanged agreement, and creates the paired delivery obligations together. A partial service failure cannot leave one player with both sides. Cancellation and compensation use the recorded order state.

If a character dies, incoming goods and held funds follow Section 20. An offline buyer may receive an ordinary completed order into storage. NPC or player courier fiction must not make settled player goods disappear through an arbitrary narrative decision. Risky transport, if introduced later, must be a separately disclosed contract with its own loss and compensation rules.

SECTION 14

Economic balance and monetization

Earned currency and circulation

Purchases between characters use earned in-game currency. Barter is supported. The baseline excludes cash-out, real-money player item sales, and purchasable hunter power. Developer planning must account for currency sources such as contracts and rewards, sinks such as appropriate service and registration fees, and material consumption through crafting and use.

Market-owner commissions redistribute money and are not automatically a currency sink. Distinguish transfers from actual removal from circulation. Monitor duplicate rewards, circular contracts, collusive trades, and NPC buy/sell combinations that create unlimited value without meaningful cost.

Essential NPC services provide a dependable baseline, particularly in sparse areas. Their prices, stock rules, and purchasing limits must not erase player specialization or support an unlimited arbitrage exploit. Avoid forcing geography-exclusive materials to become permanent barriers to basic progression; use remote trade and alternative sources where appropriate.

Valuable scarcity

Rare artifacts, unusual recipes, exceptional craftsmanship, and verified provenance can carry prestige. Basic playable roles remain accessible. Acquiring expensive equipment does not automatically confer a hunter rank or a hidden class. Personal awakenings, certifications, and character titles are not tradable inventory.

Revenue principles

Acceptable starting products include character appearances, ID themes, guild and market decorations, and optional System voice or presentation packs. Paid items stay at the account level where appropriate, so a character death does not erase the customer's unrelated cosmetic purchase.

Do not sell death-cooldown removal, Blood Debt cleansing, guaranteed rare awakenings, rank certifications, stronger combat equipment, or paid location advantages. Any future subscription must be checked against these commitments. Monetization design must be evaluated together with the economy rather than added after progression is tuned.

Measures to watch

Track currency creation and removal, prices by item family, time to fill orders, local versus remote trade, failed deliveries, wealth concentration, crafting demand, and new-player purchasing ability. Interpret price movements against actual game events. Do not mistake transaction count or manufactured trade volume for a healthy economy.

SECTION 15

Guilds and collective ownership

Founding paths

Guild creation requires an earned charter, a sufficient founding group, and completion of an organizational challenge. The earlier C-rank hunter plus five founders proposal remains a useful hunter-route planning default. A parallel civilian route uses professional standing, completed contracts, and demonstrated organization instead of hunter rank. Exact thresholds are tuning configuration.

Each guild controls admission within the platform's basic conduct rules. It can welcome unawakened members, specialize in trade or research, or set requirements for particular expeditions. Guild membership does not automatically enroll a player in lethal PvP.

Functions

Guilds provide recruitment, role permissions, scheduled expeditions, a private forum, shared projects, treasury and vault records, optional public headquarters, and an achievement history. Useful roles include scout, supplier, healer, defender, craftsperson, organizer, and expedition leader. Members should earn recognition for actual contributions.

Role permissions distinguish inviting, spending, withdrawing, changing policy, declaring an event, and managing reports. High-value withdrawals and leadership transfers need an explicit, recorded process. Membership alone is not unrestricted access to shared property.

Competition and continuity

Guild prestige grows through collective accomplishments. Competition must not let the largest guild permanently lock a region's essential gates or ordinary progression. Contested projects and later territory features use bounded windows and accessible alternatives.

A public guild marker identifies a suitable meeting location, not a member's home. Guild property belongs to the organization. Borrowed equipment records ownership and return rules. Founder death or prolonged absence invokes a configured succession process. A dead founder cannot continue commanding through archived credentials.

Guilds may investigate accusations and take permitted in-world action. A guild decision does not authorize account access, private-data disclosure, currency fabrication, or bypassing the game's PK laws.

SECTION 16

Forums, reporting, news, and sound

Community structure

The Association Board is the thematic public forum surface even before player-run associations exist. Its early operation is a system-maintained registry and communication service. It must not imply that a WHA or national government already exists in the launch build.

Boards support general discussion, public reports, recruitment, strategy, commerce notices, research, and appropriate credential-restricted spaces. Guild forums have their own access permissions. In-world conversation is encouraged, with clearly accessible out-of-character help and account support.

Evidence and knowledge

A post can contain observation, opinion, allegation, or attached system evidence. Label those distinctions. A gate report can include facts the reporter actually encountered. Secret eligibility and another character's private build are not attached automatically. Archived threads retain normal visibility and moderation rules after their authors die.

Reports of misconduct create cases for eligible reviewers. They do not automatically punish the accused, lower the accused's protection under Blood Debt, or authorize a public location reveal. Player justice and operator moderation use different tools and permissions.

Achievement-driven news

Generate bulletins from recorded qualifying events using controlled templates. Personal milestones go to friends or guildmates; substantial achievements reach a locality; exceptional events can reach regional or global audiences. Significant support, rescues, first discoveries, and civilian contributions count as possible news subjects.

The template references a real event and its eligible participants. It must not invent a victory, publicize a secret, or describe a player as famous without evidence. Major rank recognition, guild milestones, market fairs, and gate crises can receive distinctive presentation. Routine posts should not flood every user's screen.

Notifications

Offer category controls, sound choices, vibration preferences, quiet hours, and a digest option. Critical fictional status is also visible in-app. Sounds identify the game and must not imitate a real emergency authority. Push delivery is not a guaranteed survival mechanism; no unattended character should die merely because a notification was delayed or muted.

SECTION 17

NPCs, hidden quests, and discoveries

NPC roles and placement

NPCs range from ordinary information sources, suppliers, and service providers to rare travelers, investigators, patrons, and one-time questgivers. They can appear on the map, in an encounter, or through authored forum posts and replies. An ordinary request can connect to a much larger opportunity through consistent clues.

Essential services have dependable access and appropriate protection. Killability, disappearance, and replacement are explicit content properties. If an NPC can permanently die, its quests and essential functions need a defined consequence or alternative; content must not accidentally strand every later arrival.

Finite encounters

Each limited NPC or quest declares its scope: once per character, once per group, once per regional event, or once worldwide. Global uniqueness is a real server constraint, with a recorded grant. Simultaneous claim attempts must not duplicate a unique reward. The rule governing who can claim must be determined before the event opens.

Content definitions include spawn conditions, eligible audience, duration, discovery clues, acceptance conditions, objectives, failure conditions, reward limits, completion channel, and archival behavior. If a questgiver departs after accepting a commission, the definition states whether the quest fails, continues through another channel, or uses an escrowed reward.

Mystery without arbitrary outcomes

Players can compare sightings, investigate forum traces, share hypotheses, and miss genuine opportunities. Hidden quests may grant rare items or classes, while ordinary advancement remains available through other content. An expired NPC account can stop responding while its old posts remain as history.

AI-assisted dialogue, if added, is constrained by approved NPC facts and quest state. A language model cannot invent a tradable item, grant a class, change a probability, or finalize death. Authoritative game services decide outcomes; authored narrative and optional dialogue describe them.

SECTION 18

PK, evidence, and the Blood Debt law

Lethal freedom and exposure

Player killing is permitted in declared active risk areas and eligible encounters. Entering those conditions communicates exposure; the system need not request consent again for every individual hostile attack. Protected hubs, initial registration spaces, and registered trading areas use wards that prevent ordinary hostile combat. A guild membership or a forum argument does not remove those protections.

Ordinary offline or cooldown observers cannot be newly targeted. A committed encounter follows its published disconnect rules. Hostile targeting uses game encounter presence rather than an unrestricted tracker of a person's real movements.

The proposed world law

Every human carries a life seal, including the unawakened. Awakening opens the seal to channel mana. Human seals are linked by an ancient protective covenant. Initiating hostility forms a connection through which a destroyed human seal can send destructive residue back to the responsible aggressors. That residue is Blood Debt.

An aggressor temporarily exposes their own protection to the attacked party and legitimate defenders. This explains why genuine defensive action can produce little or no debt. The covenant damages a seal; it does not publish accusations, issue bounties, or enforce a country's changing political rules.

Burden rather than a universal kill count

Factor	Design effect
Unprovoked attributable death	Creates a baseline burden
Large power disparity	Increases the cost of preying on much weaker characters
Repetition within a short period	Increases accumulated strain and slows recovery
Existing seal damage	Reduces remaining capacity
Genuine self-defense or verified defense	Greatly reduces or removes the burden for that incident
Summons, traps, decisive hostile assists	Attribute responsibility to the controlling or contributing character
Player-filed bounty or accusation	Does not itself remove the target's magical protection
Mutually accepted lethal event	Uses separately disclosed participant rules and bounded modifiers

The initial aggressor and defensive relationships are computed from reliable game events. Intent is not inferred from a chat accusation. Deliberate hostile assistance can share responsibility; an unrelated heal or a mere nearby presence must not automatically establish guilt. Disputed cases require retained evidence. War modifiers cannot turn uninvolved civilians into unrestricted targets.

Consequences

Accumulating debt impairs recovery, reduces usable mana, and destabilizes abilities. Near the limit, the character sees a Seal Fracture warning. Crossing the lethal threshold through further qualifying action can cause permanent death. Strong characters do not receive an effectively unlimited allowance to kill weaker ones.

Healers can stabilize damage; recovery takes time and appropriate effort. A repeatable cheap item or premium purchase cannot erase the system. The exact thresholds are balance configuration, but a player must understand when another qualifying killing action risks fatal fracture.

Blood Debt is primarily a private condition. Specialized detection or legitimate evidence can expose relevant information. Witness reports, guild pursuit, bounties, and later association cases create public consequences only when people act. Operator intervention for exploits and real harassment remains separate from lawful in-game hostility.

SECTION 19

Gate breaks, invasions, and rescue

Event lifecycle

A regional event can progress through warning, emergence, active threat, containment, and recovery. The map displays the affected game area, available shelters, known routes, and objectives appropriate to what participants can know. Event scale accounts for available players, with useful low-population contributions and recovery paths.

Active unawakened people can be exposed and can contribute. They may report movements, carry supplies, escort another character, operate a defense device, or attempt dangerous reconnaissance. Poor decisions, failed rescues, and genuine gate accidents can result in death.

Evacuation as gameplay

Hide, take an evacuation route, request an escort, use a protective item, or defend a position are game actions. Timed resolution can consider injuries, supplies, companions, pursuers, and route conditions. Survival must not require physically sprinting, crossing unsafe ground, or chasing another person.

Successful virtual evacuation places the character in shelter. It does not validate physical presence at a remote market or permit attacks from invulnerability. Re-entering active play has a defined transition, current location validation, and any necessary restrictions on immediate re-engagement.

Offline and service conditions

Ordinary offline characters are sheltered and do not receive a newly lethal event solely because their last location is inside its radius. A character already committed to danger has a disclosed reconnect grace and fallback behavior. A planning default is a brief grace period followed by a server-controlled defensive or withdrawal attempt; exact timing must be tested alongside combat rules.

Detected service-wide failures pause lethal progression or invoke an audited recovery process. A client losing connection is not automatically proof of cheating and is not automatically an escape. The app explains its current state and the result on reconnect.

Aftermath

Verified rescues, losses, discoveries, and participating groups can affect appropriate public records. Failed containment can produce bounded virtual disruption and new recovery objectives. Event outcomes must not arbitrarily destroy protected escrow inventory or create permanent basic-progression dead ends.

SECTION 20

Permanent death, archives, and succession

Death finality

At zero HP or another specified condition, the character may become incapacitated with a disclosed rescue window. Healers, items, and companions can act during that window. Explicitly described lethal mechanics may have different outcomes. Once permanent death is finalized, normal healing and cooldown expiry cannot restore that character.

Record the cause, authoritative event, time, rule versions, affected assets, and resulting account eligibility. Finalization is idempotent: a repeated event cannot create multiple estates, extend the penalty repeatedly, or charge the same losses twice.

Cooldown and re-entry

The planning baseline is a three-day minimum, with longer waits for more established lives. Prototype examples are approximately seven days for established characters and up to fourteen for exceptional standing. These are testable defaults, not established retention findings. A disclosed cap prevents indefinite growth.

The calculation uses recorded progression, achievements, and defined standing, not raw mention counts that other users could manipulate. The current estimate is visible before lethal commitment. Lore explains the delay as the stronger imprint of an influential life taking longer to be followed by a new one.

The cooldown uses server time and account state. Reinstalling, changing the device clock, or replaying an old request cannot make that account eligible. Platform integrity and other signals support anti-evasion efforts, with a review path for false positives and shared-device cases. Absolute prevention of alternate people, accounts, or devices is not promised.

Archives and observation

Existing public information remains at its prior visibility and can show the character as deceased. Hidden achievements, private builds, and personal identity details remain private. There is no automatic obituary or public dossier for an unknown person. Other players may publish memories, allegations, or reports through normal forum rules.

During cooldown the account may inspect its records and read public content in observer mode. It cannot transact, earn in-world rewards, command a guild, vote, or post as the dead character. Out-of-character account support remains available. A new character receives a distinct identity and starts unawakened; it is not automatically linked publicly to the previous life.

Asset policy

Asset or obligation	Default outcome
Guild-owned property	Remains with the organization, including recorded loans
Carried personal items	Follow the encounter's disclosed salvage, loss, or destruction policy
Secure personal storage	Moves into a frozen estate record
Uncommitted listings and crafting inputs	Removed from active sale or work and settled to the estate under their state rules
Completed sales	Remain completed; proceeds belong to the deceased character's estate
Funded delivery or accepted commission	Completes to estate storage or follows the predeclared failure/refund rule
Account cosmetics	Remain available to the account
Rank, class, personal titles, combat power	Remain historical attributes of the dead character

The initial release has no automatic inheritance to the replacement character. Estates exist for accurate settlement, recovery investigation, and history; they are not an active ghost account. Complex wills or auctions of estates are future features requiring their own anti-evasion design. Guilds and markets must already have leadership succession and return-of-custody rules.

SECTION 21

Later national associations and WHA

Prerequisites

Player-run associations arrive after reliable multiplayer, meaningful regional communities, a functioning economy, and functioning guild society. The launch registry can provide certification interfaces and records, but it does not claim to be a player-elected national authority.

The mature model contains one recognized hunter association for each supported country and one World Hunter Association. Established real players hold offices. The WHA coordinates the national bodies and cross-border hunter affairs rather than acting as a second unrelated organization in every country.

Powers and boundaries

National bodies can recognize guilds, organize disaster response, administer permitted professional standards, investigate in-world complaints, and apply the sanctions authorized by their charter. The WHA coordinates international standards, disputes, major emergencies, and relations between associations.

Charters define eligibility, selection or elections, terms, conflicts of interest, removal, appeals, evidence access, succession after death, and the scope of sanctions. Membership and jurisdiction use explicit home-chapter and transfer rules; temporarily traveling does not silently rewrite citizenship or voting rights.

Association officers cannot change hidden awakening rules, generate items or currency, read private account data, bypass Blood Debt, or exercise operator-level account moderation. A player government can make imperfect or controversial in-world decisions within its charter. The game still retains a reliable appeal and operator-security boundary.

Political continuity

Office is attached to an eligible living character. Death, disqualification, or prolonged absence invokes succession. Public offices retain their records independently of officeholders. No replacement character automatically inherits an elected office, guild leadership, or accumulated votes from a former life.

Do not launch these institutions without enough active participants to make representation meaningful. Their data foundations can be prepared early, but visible authority follows actual rollout and adoption.

SECTION 22

Later story shaped by players

Narrative foundation

The launch may contain original lore, authored starter quests, recurring NPCs, and isolated mysteries. The later update adds a sustained world story whose direction responds to player actions. This avoids promising a living global campaign before its systems and community exist.

Record discoveries, preserved or lost NPCs, resolved or unresolved invasions, significant rescues, guild conflicts, and verified changes in trade or supplies. These records become inputs to authored branches, event conditions, and persistent world state.

Authored possibilities, emergent outcomes

Developers supply factions, motives, possible events, and coherent rules. Players influence which opportunities open, which actors survive, what regions need help, and what is remembered. Important choices can have consequences without allowing an unconstrained text generator to rewrite inventory or permanently destroy the game economy.

A scheduled event includes preconditions, participant scope, possible outcomes, affected systems, recovery routes, and required evidence. A unique world event must account for different regions and reasonable participation opportunities. It should not require an unsafe real-world rush or constant attendance to remain relevant to the game.

History and fairness

World history distinguishes canonical system events from player interpretations. News can report verified outcomes while forums debate motives. Late arrivals can discover evidence of earlier lives and events and still access meaningful new opportunities. Past heroes may remain famous; every useful future role must not already be occupied forever.

SECTION 23

Visual, audio, and interaction direction

Presentation target

The app should feel like a sophisticated personal System used by people inside its world. Use a restrained dark interface, luminous accents, clear typography, readable maps, and carefully staged moments of spectacle. Original identity, consistent icons, and responsive interactions matter more than filling every screen with glowing decoration.

Rank color, frame treatment, and sound can convey progression. Maintain readable text and an accessible high-contrast option. Detailed numbers remain available without crowding routine decisions. Use motion to explain a change, acknowledge a significant event, or dramatize an ability; routine browsing should remain calm.

Information hierarchy

Critical HP, incapacitation, current exposure, and pending trade terms are always clear. Map markers separate gate risk, access, and availability. An item detail view distinguishes rank, rarity, usability, ownership, delivery state, and actual effects. A quest hint does not masquerade as a guaranteed rare reward.

The ID must work in fullscreen display and ordinary phone use. Forums favor readable long-form discussion, linked reports, and clear authorship. Market cards support quick comparison, with exact terms at confirmation. Announcements queue without stacking over essential actions.

Accessibility and polish

Support scalable text, screen-reader labels, comfortable touch targets, reduced motion, subtitles for meaningful voice content, mute controls, and color-independent status. Offer a low-effects mode for weaker devices. Notifications respect user settings and quiet hours.

Test new-player comprehension, sunlight readability, one-handed navigation, loading and empty states, interrupted sessions, and failure recovery. Temporary artwork is acceptable in an early build if clearly tracked; a polished preview must not conceal simulated multiplayer or disconnected actions.

SECTION 24

System architecture and trust boundaries

Architecture requirements

Component	Responsibility
Client application	Render screens and encounters; collect input; request permitted actions; show confirmed state
Identity and character service	Accounts, one-living-character rule, credentials, lifecycle, cooldowns
World and encounter service	Geographic discovery, instances, combat, gates, invasions, presence
Progression and content service	Quests, hidden rules, assessments, classes, items, NPC eligibility
Economy service	Inventory ownership, currency ledger, escrow, markets, crafting, deliveries, estates
Community service	Forums, guilds, reports, news, later institutions
Scheduled work and event processing	Timed deliveries, jobs, expirations, recovery, event transitions
Operator tools and observability	Content publishing, investigations, migrations, metrics, controlled recovery

These are logical boundaries, not a requirement for eight independently deployed services. A well-structured modular application can implement the first release. The planner should avoid distributed complexity without a demonstrated need.

Authoritative decisions

The server decides ownership, currency, damage, eligibility, rewards, rank, Blood Debt, death, and cooldown expiry. A client can predict presentation but cannot declare a successful trade or a legitimate awakening. Push messages and animations describe confirmed state; they are not the canonical ledger.

Use transactional storage for critical mutations, durable scheduled work, immutable or append-only event evidence where appropriate, and idempotency for retried actions. Geospatial discovery should separate public map data from precise location evidence. Secret content is delivered only when the player is eligible to see it.

Implementation selection

The planning default is a responsive browser prototype with a real backend and a deterministic development map simulator, followed by a cross-platform mobile client or equivalent mobile build once the core loop is verified. Prototype simulation must be explicitly marked and unavailable as a production GPS override.

Choose framework, database, queue, mapping provider, and hosting through a short technical decision record. Validate current platform requirements at that time. This brief intentionally does not claim a vendor account, a map license, a native build pipeline, or a production deployment already exists.

SECTION 25

Data model and non-negotiable invariants

Core records

Domain	Required records
Identity	Account, character, public profile, credential, account cosmetic entitlement
Character state	Life state, awakening state, condition, build, progression, cooldown
World	Geographic area, hub, map entity, gate, instance, encounter membership, event
Content	Versioned class, skill, item, recipe, NPC, quest, awakening rule, reward grant
Economy	Item instance or quantity, wallet ledger entry, reservation, offer, order, shipment, crafting job, estate
Society	Guild, role, membership, treasury permission, market, vendor agreement, forum, post, report
Evidence	Combat event, responsibility attribution, assessment, death finalization, audit action, news source
Later governance	Country chapter, association, office, mandate, case, appeal, election or selection record

Invariants to preserve

1. One account has at most one living character, and no new one during its active death cooldown.
2. A permanently dead character cannot act, trade, vote, earn new active rewards, or regain its old authority.
3. An item instance has one current custodian and one consistent ownership state; stacked quantities cannot become negative.
4. Reserved, escrowed, shipped, equipped, consumed, or crafting-committed goods cannot be used in incompatible operations.
5. A settled exchange transfers its agreed sides exactly once or compensates through a recorded recovery action.
6. A unique reward has only the grants permitted by its scope, including under simultaneous requests.
7. A retry, reconnect, clock change, or replay does not reroll an awakening, duplicate a reward, or bypass a cooldown.
8. Physical proximity is required for fresh local catalog access and settlement, regardless of a character's virtual shelter location.
9. Public records never acquire previously private information merely because someone dies or is accused.
10. A report or user-entered bounty is not proof of guilt and cannot directly change combat protection.
11. Notifications, cosmetic purchases, and narrative text cannot override authoritative game state.
12. Operator recovery is explicit, permissioned, attributable, and reconciles all affected records.

Versions and evidence

Store rule and content versions with relevant outcomes. Hidden probability results and secret qualifying evidence stay private. Retention should support disputes and technical recovery while minimizing unnecessary precise location history. Aggregate world evidence can persist without retaining every raw phone coordinate indefinitely.

SECTION 26

Security, reliability, and operator controls

Threats that follow from the design

The priority threats are duplicated inventory, repeated reward claims, forged proximity, tampered clients, cooldown evasion, unauthorized guild withdrawals, false-report abuse, leaked secret rules, and inconsistent death settlement. The design also needs controls for spam, harassment, and misuse of location information.

Authenticate every sensitive action and recheck character eligibility and permission at settlement. Apply appropriate request limits and replay protection. Device integrity and suspicious-location signals supplement server validation; they are not infallible proof of intent. Avoid automatic irreversible punishment from a single noisy signal.

Operator functions

Operators need permissioned tools to inspect transactions, reconcile an order, review a report, quarantine a faulty rule, disable an unsafe map point, manage content versions, and investigate a death. Recovery actions require a reason and an audit record. Ordinary support access should not include unrestricted edits to currency or secret progression.

Provide feature controls to suspend trading, lethal outcomes, a broken event, or a faulty reward grant without taking every social and read-only surface offline. Tested backups and restore procedures must account for the economy ledger, not only screen data.

Service behavior

Planning targets should cover acceptable response time, concurrent encounter behavior, reconnect success, ledger consistency, and scheduled-job completion. Choose measurable targets after selecting the pilot size and infrastructure; do not invent a supported global player count before load testing.

The first production pilot must have working alerts for failed settlements, repeated job execution, impossible balances, abnormal reward supply, and failures during death finalization. A client must be able to recover the confirmed outcome of an action after losing its response.

Operational ownership

Player institutions handle their permitted in-world affairs. The operator handles account access, exploit response, infrastructure, data protection, and real harassment. User-facing help and appeals remain available during character cooldown. Public distribution requires current platform, age-suitability, permission, and data-handling checks appropriate to the chosen release; those checks belong in release planning rather than being invented as lore.

SECTION 27

End-to-end acceptance scenarios

The following scenarios turn the concept into observable outcomes. They are requirements for meaningful verification, not a claim that tests have already run against an implemented game.

ID	Scenario	Required result
A01	New account creates a character	It starts unawakened, receives an identity, and can use civilian services
A02	Same account requests another living character	The request fails without creating a duplicate
A03	Unawakened player enters an eligible difficult gate	Clear risk is shown; entry can proceed; normal consequences apply
A04	Eligible awakening trigger is retried	One recorded outcome and one grant; no reroll
A05	Healer completes a role-specific assessment	Certification reflects the assessment, not a damage-only threshold
A06	QR card is scanned by another player	Only permitted public data and invitation actions are available
A07	Two buyers attempt to purchase one item	At most one succeeds; the other receives a clear updated result
A08	A direct-trade offer changes after confirmation	Prior acceptances clear; both players must confirm the new version
A09	Local shopper leaves the radius before settlement	The transaction does not bypass the proximity rule
A10	Virtual evacuation ends at a distant hub	The character is sheltered but cannot browse that hub's local inventory remotely
A11	World Exchange order completes while buyer is offline	Goods arrive once in the intended storage without travel
A12	Purchased shipment contains an acceleration item	That item cannot accelerate its own arrival before it is owned and usable
A13	Crafting completion is delivered twice	Exactly one permitted output and one settlement occur
A14	Quest reward is worldwide unique and two players qualify	The defined selection rule grants only the permitted supply
A15	Innocent character is reported or given a user bounty	No automatic guilt, location reveal, or Blood Debt exemption follows
A16	A summon causes an attributable PK	Responsibility follows the controlling character under the declared rules
A17	Defensive kill meets verified defense conditions	The appropriate reduced or zero Blood Debt result is recorded
A18	Character crosses a fatal Blood Debt threshold	The disclosed rule finalizes the correct death once

ID	Scenario	Required result
A19	Character dies with a funded order and guild equipment	Estate settlement honors the order; collective ownership remains intact
A20	Dead character's old post is opened	Original permitted history remains; no new private dossier appears
A21	Player reinstalls or changes device time during cooldown	Server eligibility remains unchanged for that account
A22	Offline civilian's last location lies in a new invasion	No newly lethal exposure is created solely from that location
A23	Client loses a response after a successful trade	Reconnect retrieves the same receipt without repeating the exchange
A24	A service-wide failure interrupts lethal resolution	The documented freeze or audited recovery policy applies consistently
A25	Guild or market founder dies	Succession and custody rules execute without deleting collective work
A26	A news template processes an achievement twice	No duplicate bulletin or invented public fact is created
A27	Cooldown expires	A new unawakened identity may be created; the previous one stays dead
A28	A player officer requests operator-only data	Permission is denied and the attempt is recorded appropriately

Additional exploratory testing should cover sparse regions, inaccessible map points, weak devices, text scaling, muted notifications, economic collusion, and players who prefer civilian careers. Broaden tests to resolve a concrete risk rather than adding checks that only repeat the implementation.

SECTION 28

Rollout stages and release gates

Stage 0: specification and technical planning

Produce the requirements backlog, dependency map, threat and failure model, data design, initial content definitions, visual direction, and technical decisions. Resolve the planning items in Section 30. Preserve the complete vision but do not require every later institution before the first playable build.

Stage 1: playable foundation

Build registration, one-character state, the System panel, fullscreen ID, a development map and eligible live-map view, civilian work, one complete gate, a small combat kit, inventory, saved progression, and one controlled awakening route. The objective is an end-to-end playable loop with confirmed state. Show simulation labels where relevant.

Exit when a new tester can create an unawakened character, understand its condition, choose a task, enter an encounter, acquire an item, and return to the same saved state. Foundational identity and ownership tests must pass.

Stage 2: multiplayer alpha

Add real multi-account presence, parties, direct trades, personal stalls, basic guilds, crafting, NPC quests, forums, and a local bulletin. Introduce the World Exchange and registered markets after the shared transaction and reservation system is reliable. Test death, estates, and cooldowns in a controlled environment before relying on them for irreversible public play.

Exit when independent players can cooperate, trade, craft, and recover consistently from interrupted requests. Meaningful simultaneous-purchase and reward-retry tests must pass. A small group should demonstrate voluntary repeat use and actual interaction.

Stage 3: regional mobile beta

Use one supported launch region and a concentrated group of testers. Deliver real-device GPS, notification, battery, and accessibility validation. Enable the intended lethal risk rules only after death, PK attribution, archives, succession, and incident recovery have passed their gates. Add limited invasion events and a small, well-tested specialization catalog.

Exit when the economy and ordinary operations remain stable through real play and known failure simulations. Measure whether players understand danger, return after loss, find trade partners, and value civilian roles. Adjust declared tuning parameters with evidence.

Stage 4: regional expansion and society

Expand content, professions, rare paths, market capacity, meaningful regional events, and community tools. Add larger fairs or auctions after transaction behavior and local liquidity justify them. Expand geography only with dependable encounter supply, community support, and operations.

Stage 5: mature institutions and evolving campaign

Introduce functioning national associations and the WHA when representation and worldwide operations are viable. Add the sustained player-shaped story using the history accumulated by earlier systems. These features remain explicitly later updates until their prerequisites are met.

SECTION 29

Evaluation, balance, and commercial realism

What success means initially

The first test is whether people enjoy inhabiting a character and want to return. Measure completion of the first useful task, comprehension of risk, repeat sessions, successful parties, voluntary ID sharing, trade completion, and participation by unawakened players. Test whether the interface communicates a hunter world without long explanations.

Severe-loss design

Permanent death, open PK, and a multi-day return delay are deliberate parts of this concept. Their combination is also a major retention uncertainty. Test understanding and return behavior after actual controlled losses. Distinguish dissatisfaction with an intended consequence from an unfair loss caused by unclear rules, false attribution, or a technical fault.

Keep the owner informed if evidence suggests changes to a core rule. Do not quietly convert death into ordinary respawn to improve a metric. Present the trade-off and a concrete alternative before changing the baseline.

Fair opportunities

Track access to encounters in sparse areas, new-player progress, support-role assessment outcomes, concentration of rare rewards, and local market stock. A world containing powerful rankers still needs useful work and meaningful discoveries for everyone else. Seasonal standing and local recognition create fresh opportunities without erasing persistent identity.

Costs and operations

Prepare a cost model after selecting the stack and target pilot size. Include maps, hosting, storage, background jobs, monitoring, moderation, content production, device testing, and optional AI services. Do not describe this brief as evidence that a worldwide game can be operated without cost or staff attention.

AI can assist design, code, testing, content, and iteration. Core economic and lethal decisions remain ordinary, testable game rules. A finished-looking interface is not evidence of multiplayer reliability, and a prototype is not an app-store release until the required build and distribution work is complete.

SECTION 30

Planning decisions and starting defaults

Use these defaults for the next development plan. Numerical examples are tuning proposals; choose final values through testing. Keep hidden awakening criteria private and development simulations separate from live permissions.

Decision	Starting position	Evidence or action needed
Commercial name	Hunter World is a descriptive working label	Choose and check the final identity before marketing
Launch region	One accessible, concentrated pilot region	Select based on actual tester access and suitable locations
Initial development surface	Responsive browser build with real backend	Confirm route to intended mobile clients and device testing
Technical stack	Modular application, transactional ledger, durable jobs, geospatial discovery	Compare current candidates and record the selection
Combat	Tactical turn-based solo play and bounded party rounds	Prototype timing, readability, support value, and retreat
Starting archetypes	Six awakened combat archetypes plus civilian professions	Author a small complete catalog and assess distinctiveness
Direct-trade radius	Approximately 100 meters	Test GPS uncertainty, accessibility, and actual meeting behavior
Local-market radius	Approximately 150 meters	Test valid browsing and settlement across real locations
Guild hunter founding path	C-rank route and five founders as an initial model	Set equivalent civilian founding criteria and tune group size
Market founding	License quest, contract history, registration, valid location, stock	Tune thresholds without making launch areas empty
Death cooldown	Three-day floor; example tiers around seven and fourteen days, with a disclosed cap	Test comprehension and return behavior before public scale
Blood Debt	Weighted, attributable burden with visible critical warnings	Specify coefficients, defense windows, recovery, and edge cases
Delivery	Fixed destination and disclosed ETA with earned acceleration	Tune timings, fees, storage behavior, and failure policies
Disconnects	Brief grace followed by server-resolved fallback	Test honest interruptions and deliberate evasion together
Public release audience	Appropriate age and permissions for the chosen regions and stores	Complete current release review before distribution
Later governance	One association per supported country and one WHA	Establish viable population, charters, and operating capacity

SECTION 31

Competitive context and source notes

What the initial research established

The concept combines existing categories in a particular way. GPS exploration, fantasy classes, raids, guild-like groups, character cards, and nearby trading each have precedents. The clearest proposed distinction is the integrated modern hunter society: civilian life, one living character, hidden awakening, geographic and remote commerce, player-created reputation, consequential death, and later player government.

Product	Verified overlap	Relevance
Orna	GPS RPG, classes, dungeons, kingdoms, raids, world events	Closest broad gameplay comparison [S1]
Magic Streets	GPS fantasy exploration, classes, guilds, trading, raids	Another close comparison for world and commerce [S2]
Monster Hunter Now	Geographic hunting, cooperative play, equipment, Guild Cards, mapped groups	Useful comparison for encounters, identity, and gatherings [S3-S5]
Ingress	Portals, map-based faction activity, coordination, in-world interface	Useful comparison for collective geographic activity [S6]
LootQuest	GPS exploration, turn-based combat, narrative quests, loot	Useful comparison for short exploration and combat loops [S7]
ARISE SOLO	System-style ranks, quests, personal progression, GPS running	Adjacent fitness experience rather than the same game scope [S8]
Pokemon GO	Nearby trading documented by its official help center	Precedent for proximity exchange [S9]

Research was checked on 11 September 2026 using official product pages and current store listings. Those sources indicate advertised features and availability; they are not measurements of active-player population. No verified source found during the review established an identical complete feature package. This is not proof of exclusive originality or a prediction of commercial demand.

Technical source boundaries

Google's Play Integrity documentation describes signals for genuine app and device interactions and recommends using them alongside other anti-abuse measures [S10]. This supports a layered approach, not an absolute promise to identify every person or stop every alternate account.

OpenAI's Astra documentation describes multistep software-engineering capabilities [S11]. It supports using Astra as a development collaborator. It does not establish that this particular game has been implemented, audited, balanced, or prepared for worldwide operation.

References

[S1] Orna, official Google Play listing:
https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?hl=en_US&id=playorna.com.orna

[S2] Magic Streets, official Google Play listing:
https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?hl=en_US&id=com.builditgames.magicstreets

[S3] Monster Hunter Now, How to Play: https://monsterhunternow.com/en/howtoplay/overview

[S4] Monster Hunter Now, Guild Card:
https://niantic.helpshift.com/hc/en/39-monster-hunter-now/faq/4466-guild-card/

[S5] Monster Hunter Now, Groups and Meetups:
https://niantic.helpshift.com/hc/en/39-monster-hunter-now/faq/4756-groups-and-meetups-1731173010/

[S6] Ingress, official Google Play listing:
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[S7] LootQuest, official Google Play listing:
https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?hl=en_US&id=com.virtualcoma.lootquest

[S8] ARISE SOLO, official Google Play listing: https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=arisesolo.com

[S9] Pokemon GO, Trading Pokemon: https://niantic.helpshift.com/hc/en/6-pokemon-go/faq/96-trading-pokemon/

[S10] Google, Play Integrity API overview: https://developer.android.com/google/play/integrity/overview

[S11] OpenAI, Using GPT-6 Astra: https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/guides/latest-model

SECTION 32

Astra handoff and completeness checklist

Ready-to-use planning instruction

Use this PDF as the baseline product and game-design brief for the project. Read the entire document before planning. Preserve the owner's latest requirements and distinguish core rules from configurable defaults, content examples, and later updates. Do not substitute a different game with ordinary respawn, forced class selection at registration, remote access to local-only inventories, or automatically generated public death dossiers.

First produce a build plan: requirements by release stage, dependencies, technical decisions, data model, state transitions, authoritative operations, critical failure handling, initial content scope, and testable acceptance criteria. Resolve Section 30 using explicit recommendations. Keep a decision log and versioned game bible in the project's source of truth.

Build the first complete playable milestone and verify it before expanding. Use real persisted accounts and authoritative state where the milestone requires them. Mark development simulations clearly. Keep hidden awakening rules, reward eligibility, and operational secrets out of the public client. Treat trading, deliveries, crafting, PK attribution, and death settlement as connected stateful systems.

Polish the interface through rendered inspection and practical playtesting. Verify failure and reconnect flows as well as successful ones. Keep national associations, the WHA, and the sustained player-shaped campaign in their later stages until prerequisites are demonstrated. Report what is implemented, what is verified, what is simulated, and the next concrete milestone without claiming untested readiness.

Integrated feature check

Requirement	Where defined
One living character, unawakened start, civilian participation	04-05
System panel, fullscreen ID, quick HP/MP and body status	06
Geographic gates, guilds, markets, NPCs, nearby presence; no AR	07-08
Hidden awakening, classes, subclasses, rare and mythic paths	09, 17
Ranked items, crafting, healer and smith-related careers	10
Direct trades, solo stalls, qualified physical markets	11-12
Remote market, timed delivery, earned bypass items or statuses	13
Fair economy and cosmetic monetization	14
Guild creation including civilian route, recruitment, projects, succession	15
Roleplaying forums, evidence, player news, sounds, notifications	16
Map and forum NPCs, finite hidden class and item quests	17
PK, player-driven justice, weighted limit and Blood Debt lore	18
Gate accidents, breaks, invasions, hiding, evacuation, rescue	19
Permanent death, retained existing history, no automatic obituary	20
Multi-day server cooldown, new life, estates, no ghost authority	20
Later country associations and single WHA run by players	21
Later world story shaped by player actions	22
Visual and audio polish, architecture, ownership invariants	23-26
Acceptance scenarios, rollout, validation, planning decisions	27-30
Competition, sources, and next-chat handoff	31-32

Baseline completion statement

This brief contains the complete integrated app idea at the level needed to begin technical planning and staged development. Remaining numerical tuning, platform selection, launch geography, and final content catalogs are identified work items rather than hidden assumptions. The next deliverable is the implementation plan and its first verifiable playable milestone.